

Desk Research Mapping for GP2

This document explains how the different parts of the desk research contribute to the GP2 study. It clarifies the purpose of each research part, what it validates, and how it must be used in the report to strengthen academic quality and assessment alignment.

Overview of the Three Desk Research Parts

Research Part	What it is mainly about	Level of relevance to GP2	What it validates in its own context	How it must be used in GP2
Part 1 – Broad protocol patterns and examples	Shows that semi structured interviews are commonly used to study documentation, reproducibility, reuse, and handover. Also shows common structural patterns such as core and supplemental blocks, lifecycle logic, barriers, and gaps.	Medium to High	Validates that the overall approach is academically legitimate, including the use of semi structured interviews, topic blocks, probing for gaps, and the use of desk research to support design choices.	Use to justify interview instrument design in the Methodology section. Explain that the structure of the guide follows established qualitative research practice. Cite when explaining why the interview includes core questions, probes, and a focus on documentation, reuse, and traceability.

Part 2 – Studies closest to your population and constructs	Focuses directly on students, supervisors, labs, and reproducibility, with real studies that ask about documentation habits, reuse, loss between cohorts, handover, and barriers.	Very High	Validates that the constructs being studied are real research constructs, such as documentation quality, reuse gaps, handover failures, and supervisor expectations. Also validates that the question types are academically normal.	Use to justify the operationalisation of the study. Show that interview questions map directly onto constructs already studied in peer reviewed research. This strengthens construct validity in GP2.
Part 3 – Mature published interview protocols with visible guides	Established studies with explicit interview guides in appendices. Strong focus on lifecycle logic, critical incidents, decision traceability, institutional barriers, and reuse.	High	Validates that the interview guide operates at research grade methodological depth, not just student level. Confirms that asking about lifecycle stages, critical incidents, decision logging, and handover is academically legitimate.	Use to justify the credibility and rigor of the interview instrument. Cite these sources when explaining that the guide is informed by published protocols and aligns with best practice in reproducibility and research data management research.

Short Synthesis for GP2 Use

Part 1 supports the structure of the interview.

Part 2 supports the constructs and content of the questions.

Part 3 supports the methodological rigor and academic legitimacy of the instrument.

Together, they provide three layers of validation. Conceptual validation shows that the study investigates real constructs. Methodological validation shows that the interview style is standard in the field. Instrument validation shows that the actual questions align with published practice.

Research Part 1

Purpose of this part

The purpose of this part is to justify how the interview instrument was constructed and why it is methodologically sound.

Study	Relevant to GP2	What it strengthens in GP2	How it must be used in the report
Kallio et al., 2016	Yes, strongly	Supports data collection quality by showing that the interview guide was developed using established methodological logic rather than intuition. Strengthens credibility and reliability of instrument design.	Cite in the Methodology section when explaining how the interview guide was developed. Use it to justify structured question blocks, use of prior literature, iterative refinement, and alignment between research questions and the instrument.
DeJonckheere and Vaughn, 2019	Yes	Supports proper use of qualitative method. Helps defend probing, flexibility, and the semi structured format as academically correct.	Use when describing interview execution. This strengthens the methodological defense if subjectivity or bias is questioned.
Feger et al., 2019 (optional)	Moderate	Supports problem framing by showing that tooling alone does not solve reproducibility issues and that workflow and structure matter.	Use sparingly in background or discussion. Do not use as core methodological justification. It supports interpretation, not instrument design.

Verdict for Part 1

This part is valid and valuable for GP2 only when it is clearly linked to how the interview instrument was designed and how this improves reliability and credibility of data collection. Without this link, it risks appearing as filler.

Research Part 2

Purpose of this part

The purpose of this part is to prove that the research focus is not self invented, but grounded in legitimate academic research topics.

Study	Relevant to GP2	What it strengthens in GP2	How it must be used in the report
Chen et al., 2022	Yes, very strongly	Strengthens credibility of constructs such as documentation practices, tools, informal learning, and variability in student research. Confirms that these topics can be studied through interviews.	Use in the Literature Review to show that student research practices are a valid object of study. Refer back to it in the Discussion when comparing your findings with theirs.
Lalu et al., 2023	Yes	Strengthens the problem logic. Shows that barriers to rigorous practice are structural and behavioral, not personal failure. Supports the argument that structure and incentives matter.	Use in the Background or Context section to ground the problem academically. Use again in the Discussion when interpreting resistance, gaps, or contradictions in your data.

Verdict for Part 2

This part is highly relevant to GP2 because it protects against the critique that the constructs are invented by the student. It demonstrates that documentation gaps, reuse issues, and practice inconsistency are recognized research phenomena.

Research Part 3

Purpose of this part

The purpose of this part is to demonstrate that the interview guide is not amateurish, but aligned with serious published protocols. This directly supports the credibility of data collection, the reliability of the instrument, and the defense against claims of subjective questioning.

Study	Relevant to GP2	What it strengthens in GP2	How it must be used in the report
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Kralj and Landwehr, 2025	Yes, strongly	Shows that lifecycle based questioning is used in published research. Strengthens the methodological legitimacy of the interview structure.	Use in the Methodology section when justifying the structure of the interview guide. Explicitly state that your structure aligns with published RDM interview designs.
Ithaka S+R, 2019	Yes, strongly	Provides concrete precedent for asking about tools, storage, daily practices, and future reuse. Validates the operational focus of the questions.	Use in the Methodology to justify why questions focus on practices rather than abstract opinions. Useful when defending the interview as research grade.
Burnette et al., 2016	Yes, very strongly	Uniquely supports the handover focus. Shows that role transitions and long term effects of documentation are legitimate interview topics.	Must be used when justifying why handover questions are explicitly included. Strengthens construct validity for continuity.
Vicente Saez et al., 2020	Moderate	Supports discussion of institutional environment and incentives rather than interview design.	Use in the Discussion section when interpreting systemic barriers and organizational context.

Final Note

Together, these three desk research parts create a coherent foundation for GP2. They ensure that the study is theoretically grounded, methodologically defensible, and instrumentally credible. This strengthens alignment with assessment criteria on data collection quality, methodological rigor, and the legitimacy of conclusions drawn from the research.

References (APA Style)

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